

SilverTech Directory — Tour Guide

20 Questions to Ask on Your Nursing Home Tour

Skilled nursing facilities are regulated more heavily than other care types. You have rights — and so does your loved one. Use these questions to hold facilities accountable.

Regulatory Standing

1. **What is your current CMS star rating**, and when was your last health inspection?
2. **Can I see your most recent state inspection report?** (You are entitled to this by law.)
3. **Have there been any deficiencies or fines** in the past two years? How were they resolved?
4. **What is your current occupancy rate?**

Staffing

5. **What is the nurse-to-resident ratio on each shift** — day, evening, and overnight?
6. **Are Registered Nurses (RNs) on site 24 hours**, or just Licensed Practical Nurses (LPNs) or aides?
7. **What is your staff turnover rate** over the past year?
8. **How are agency or temporary staff used**, and how are they trained to your standards?

Medical Care

9. **Who is the attending physician**, and how often do they visit residents?
10. **How are medication changes and new orders communicated** to family members?
11. **What is your policy on restraints** — physical and chemical?
12. **How do you manage pain**, particularly for residents who cannot self-report?

Rehabilitation

13. **What rehabilitation services are available on-site** — physical, occupational, and speech therapy?
14. **How is the discharge planning process handled**, and who is involved?
15. **What is your average rehab stay length** for someone recovering from a hip replacement?

Daily Life & Dignity

16. **How are residents' daily preferences respected** — wake time, meal preferences, activities?
17. **What is your grievance process** if a resident or family has a complaint?
18. **How are roommate assignments made**, and what if there's a conflict?

Costs & Rights

19. **What does Medicare cover vs. what is private pay**, and for how long?
20. **Can I speak with the Resident Council** or a family member currently using this facility?

A good nursing home will welcome your questions. Reluctance to answer is itself an answer.

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